

CHE 499

1. Course number and name

CHE 499. Professional Development Seminar

2. Credits, contact hours and categorization

Credit hours: 0; Contact hours: 10-12 seminars/lectures per semester; Engineering

3. Instructor's or course coordinator's name

Alan Zdunek

4. Text book, title, author, publisher, year

None

5. Specific course information

a. Brief description of the content of the course (catalog description)

Seminar-based course. Invited speakers provide information on industries hiring chemical engineers, job-related experience, traditional and non-traditional chemical engineering career paths, and career advice. Career development information from Engineering Career Center. Student evaluation of their educational experience in the Chemical Engineering Department including senior exit survey and ethics exam.

b. Prerequisites or co-requisites

Open only to chemical engineering seniors, Must be taken in the last (Fall) semester of study.

c. Indicate whether a required, elective, or selected elective.

Required.

6. Specific goals for the course

a. Specific outcomes of instruction. Students will:

- Interact with practicing chemical engineers
- Learn about traditional and non-tradition chemical engineering career paths, both in academia and industry
- Learn job searching skills; networking, resume writing, interviewing skills, salary negotiation
- Learn what industries hire chemical engineers
- Learn about their role as UIC Chemical Engineering alumni
- Relate their UIC educational experience in an exit survey

b. Explicitly indicate which of the student outcomes are addressed by the course.

Student Learning Outcome	1	2	3	4
(3) an ability to communicate effectively with a range of audiences.			X	
(4) an ability to recognize ethical and professional responsibilities in engineering situations and make informed judgments, which must consider the impact of engineering solutions in global, economic, environmental, and societal contexts.			X	
(7) an ability to acquire and apply new knowledge as needed, using appropriate learning strategies.			X	

7. Brief list of topics to be covered

- Where chemical engineers work: Chemical engineering-related industries
- Traditional and non-traditional chemical engineering career paths
- Chemical engineering job-related experience
- Career development information: job searching, resume writing, interviewing skills, salary negotiation, networking, alumni contacts.
- Ethics in the workplace

Selected Seminar Speakers from past years:

Job-Searching Skills: Jonna McHugh, UIC Engineering Career Center

Consulting: Kevin Meaux, Harbour Contractors

Safety/Environment: Lissa Aquino, Stepan Chemicals

Research & Development: Dr. George Foutou, Cabot Microelectronics

Business Management: Ryan Neris, ErgoSeal

Process Engineering-Food: Rick Burns, Tetrapak, Food process engineering

Entrepreneurship: Dr. Said Al-Hallaj, AllCell Technology, Entrepreneurship

Chemical Engineering Role in Sustainability: Dr. Gavin Towler, UOP

Oil/Gas Process Engineering: Elizabeth Carter, UOP

Food Industry: Brian Guthrie, Cargill

Food Industry: Lynette Hernandez, Nestle USA

Petrochemicals: Anastasia Vaia, BP Aromatics Technologies

Process Control-Food: Thomas Scheller, ProLeiT

Patent Agent: Daniel Hernandez

Automotive: Arwa Hasan, Navistar

Sales: Pedro Lopez, Spraying Systems, Inc.